cow slaughter must be put from an economic, social and sentimental point of view.'

As Madhok told a questioner, 'In the directive principles of our Constitution, we have already laid down that cow-killing would be stopped in the whole of India. At that time, Jana Sangh was not in existence. At that time we had no member in the Constituent Assembly. It was the Congress-dominated Constituent Assembly which made the Constitution of India. So far as our approach is concerned, cow is an animal which has been absolutely essential for Indian economy from the earliest time.'[140]

In 1966, the working committee of the Jan Sangh adopted a resolution extending support to the all-party Cow Protection Movement for a total ban on cow slaughter. The resolution said that the Constitution must be amended to enact a law banning cow slaughter and said the blame should not be shifted to state governments. It charged the Centre with 'disregarding national sentiments and taking recourse to evasive and dilatory tactics to mislead the people' when the primary responsibility for cow slaughter extended to the Union government.[141]

That same year, on 7 November, thousands of sadhus and others attacked the Parliament building in Delhi, demanding a national ban on cow slaughter. Indira Gandhi defused the crisis by getting the home minister to resign and setting up a high-powered committee, under A.K. Sarkar, retired chief justice of the Supreme Court, on 29 June 1967, to examine the issue of a national ban. The committee was given six months to submit its report.

One of the members of the Justice Sarkar Committee was RSS Sarsanghchalak M.S. Golwalkar. The committee met for twelve years but produced no report. As the Congress's Jairam Ramesh says, the only accounts of the committee are in two memoirs. Ashok Mitra, the Marxist economist, and Verghese Kurien, the founder of Amul—who were both members—have written about it, and quite delightfully.[142] The committee was ultimately wound up in 1979 by Prime Minister Morarji Desai, without any report being submitted. Jairam Ramesh, who researched the cow issue, says that perhaps an account may still be preserved in the home ministry's deep archives, but there is no record of it in any public archive.